

Installing Python

Before you can use the Python programming language, you need to download and install it on your computer. Python 3 is free, easy to install, and works on Windows PCs, Macs, and Linux operating systems such as Ubuntu.

What is IDLE?

When you install Python 3, you'll also get a free program called IDLE (Integrated DeveLopment Environment). Designed for beginners, IDLE includes a basic text editor that allows you to write and edit Python code.

WINDOWS

△ Windows

Before you download Python, check what kind of operating system your computer has. If you have Windows, find out whether it's the 32-bit or 64-bit version. Click the "Start" button, right-click "Computer", and left-click "Properties". Then choose "System" if the option appears.



EXPERT TIPS

Saving code

When saving work in Python, you will need to use the "File > Save As..." menu command so you can name your files. First create a folder to keep all your files in. Give the folder a clear name, like "PythonCode", and agree with the person who owns the computer where to keep it.



MAC

△ Mac

If you use an Apple Mac, find out which operating system it has before you install Python. Click the apple icon in the top left and choose "About This Mac".



UBUNTU

△ Ubuntu

Ubuntu is a free operating system that works just like Windows and Macs. To find out how to install Python on Ubuntu, turn to page 91.

